

So, now that your rough character sketch is ready, and you can go ahead and proceed with filling it with colours and elements. Let's get to that step now.

Filling the symbols of the character with content

You can start the rough sketch, also called an empty container by filling the container with shapes and clean up the character to give it a proper shape and look.

All the shapes that you draw must be in flow and define the joints. You can draw each shape on different layers so that you can arrange them accordingly.

You can practice drawing characters on Adobe Illustrator before jumping into Adobe Animate to understand how to build a character from scratch. Once you are habitual of drawing your characters on Illustrator, then you can apply the same skills to animate your illustration.

With Adobe's export features, you can export your drawings from one application to another.

Rigging the character head

Rigging the character head is one of the most time consuming and tedious tasks of all. The problem here is that it requires a lot of detailing, attention and precision. We, humans, tend to look at the slightest details of any face while watching animated movies and tv shows.

So, you must make sure that the character looks solid and the facial structures are well-built with revealing eyes that give life and emotion to your animated character.

The central part of the head to start with is the skull, then you can touch up other elements separately and convert them into symbols. Those will be eye sockets, ears, eye whites, irises, eyebrows, etc.

When you import your character from ai or psd, you can see a puppet panel. Above all these, there are four options – start, rig, record and stream. Click on the Rig option.

In the puppet panel, you will see tags – you will see the head with all the facial features and mouth shapes.

You can see how the rigging of the facial features and head are mapped according to their names, which you can further edit accordingly. The head is usually compatible with the main timeline. So, you can set the head symbol to “play once”.